Articles

a, an, the

Indefinite (a/an)

Definite (the)

Indefinite Articles

a – ஒரு **an** – ஒர்

01. We use “a/an” for singular countable nouns.

Ex: **a** dog.
a book.
a pen.
an apple.
an orange.
an umbrella.

~~a water~~
~~a milk~~
~~an oil~~

02. We use the article “a” for nouns start with a consonant sound.

Ex: **a** bicycle.
a girl.
a teacher.
a university.

03.We use the article “an” for nouns start with a vowel sound.

Ex: **an** elephant.
an ant.
an ice cream.
an eagle.

N→ If there is an “adjective” before the noun we consider the sound of the adjective.

Ex: a small bicycle.
A large umbrella.
A pink ice cream.
A big elephant.
An honor girl.
An English teacher.

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இவற்றை இலகுவாக கற்பதற்கான ஒரு வழி உள்ளது. அதாவது ஆங்கிலத்தில் காணப்படும் உயிரொலி, மெய்யொலியும் தமிழில் காணப்படும் உயிரொலி, மெய்யொலியும் ஒத்தவைகளாகும்.

உயிர் எழுத்துக்கள் - Vowels

மெய் எழுத்துக்கள் - Consonants

ஆங்கிலத்தில் **5** உயிரெழுத்துக்களும், தமிழில் **12** உயிரெழுத்துக்களும் காணப்படுகின்றன

உயிர் எழுத்துக்கள் ; அ, ஆ, இ, ஈ, உ, ஊ, எ, ஏ, ஐ, ஒ, ஓ, ஔ. **இவை தவிற மற்றைய சொற்கள் மெய்யெழுத்துக்களாகும்.**
Vowels ; A, E, I, O, U **Remaining words are consonants.**

குறித்த சொல்லானது உயிரொலியுடன் ஆரம்பிக்குமாயின் அதற்கு முன்பாக ஓர்/ **an** என்பதனை பயன்படுத்த வேண்டும்.

குறித்த சொல்லானது மெய்யொலியுடன் ஆரம்பிக்குமாயின் அதற்கு முன்பாக ஒரு/ **a** என்பதனை பயன்படுத்த வேண்டும்.

a bus (ப)

an apple (எ)

a book (பு)

an umbrella (அ)

a teacher (ஆ)

an elephant (எ)

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Activity

01._an_____ ice- cream (ஐ)

02._a_____ university (யு)

03._an_____ ant (ஏ)

04._an_____ eagle (ஈ)

05._a_____ small bicycle (ஸ)

06._an_____ hour (அ)

07._an_____ English teacher (இ)

08._an_____ SMS (எ)

09._an____ honor (ஓ)

10._a_____ uniform (யு)

11._a_____ hotel (ஓ)

12._a_____ union (யூ)

13._an_____ honest man (ஓ)

14.I am __a___ BA graduate. (பீ)

15.I am __an___ MA graduate. (எ)

16._an____ egg (எ)

17._a____ tree (ட்)

18._an____ orange (ஓ)

19._an____ elbow (எ)

20._a____ fish (பி)

21._an____ eye (ஐ)

22._an____ animal (எ)

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Definite Article (the)

01. We can use the article "the" in front of singular, plural and uncountable nouns.

Ex:- the cat ------→ **singular**
the pens ------→ **plural**
the milk ------→ **uncountable**

02. We can use "the" to make general things specific.

a/an

There are *three* windows here.
a window = window 1 or 2 or 3

- I've got **a car**. (there are many cars and I've got one)
- Can I ask **a question**? (there are many questions – can I ask one?)
- Is there **a hotel** near here? (there are many hotels – is there one near here?)
- Paris is **an interesting city**. (there are many interesting cities and Paris is one)
- Lisa is **a student**. (there are many students and Lisa is one)

the

There is only *one* window here – **the** window.

- I'm going to clean **the car** tomorrow. (= my car)
- Can you repeat **the question**, please? (= the question that you asked)
- We enjoyed our holiday. **The hotel** was very nice. (= our hotel)
- Paris is **the capital of France**. (there is only one capital of France)
- Lisa is **the youngest student** in her class. (there is only one youngest student in her class)

03. Rivers, mountain rangers, seas, oceans and geographic areas all use “the”

Ex: The Nile.
The Alps.
The Atlantic Ocean.
The South Asia.

04. Unique things have “the”

Ex: The sun.
The moon.
The earth.

05. Industrial buildings don’t have an article, if you visit them for the reason these building exist.
Ex: She is in hospital at the moment. (She’s ill)

But if you go to the building for another reason, you must use “the”
Ex: Her husband goes to **the** hospital to see her every afternoon.

- I go to school ----------→ I am a student.
- I go to **the** school ------→I amn’t a student. I go there for a reason.

06. Musical instruments use “the”
Ex: She plays **the piano**.
He plays **the guitar**.
They play **the flute**.

07. Countries.
- We don’t use an article if the country is singular.

Ex: I live in Sri Lanka.

- But if the country’s name has a plural meaning, we use “the”

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Ex: The people's republic of China.

The Netherlands.

The United States of America.

08. Theatres, cinemas and hotels have the.

Ex: The Savoy.
The Willmax.
The Hilton.

09. Abbreviations use "the"

Ex: The UN.
The USA.
The IMF.

10. We use "the" before classes of people.

Ex: The rich.
The poor.
The Tamils.
The British.

11. Jobs use "a/an"

Ex: I'm a teacher.
She is an English teacher.
Shalini is a doctor.

Do not use any articles with these types of nouns.

- Continents, towns and streets don't have an article.
  Ex: Africa ---------→ Continent Church street ----------→ street

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New York ---------→ City

- Illness don't have an article.
  Ex: He has got appendicitis.

  But we say "a cold" and "a headache".

- Sports don't have an article.
  Ex: He plays football.
  She plays netball.
  They play elle.

The ----------→ த /தி

- If we pronounce a word with the vowel sound we should say "தி"
- If we pronounce a word with the consonant sound, we should say "த"

Ex: The {தி} elephant. (எ)
The {த} ball.
The {த} pencil.
The {தி} English.

The {த} Sri Lanka.
The {தி} India.
The {தி} SMS.
The {தி} exercises.

TRY

01. தி ice – cream.
02. த university.
03. த small bicycle.
04. த uniform.
05. த hotel.
06. தி honest man
07. த tree.
08. தி elbow.
09. தி eye.
10. தி animal.

Questions

Write a/an or the.

1 We enjoyed our trip. ___The___ hotel was very nice.
2 'Can I ask ___a___ question?' 'Sure. What do you want to know?'
3 You look very tired. You need ____ holiday.
4 'Where's Tom?' 'He's in ____ garden.'
5 Eve is ____ interesting person. You should meet her.
6 A: Excuse me, can you tell me how to get to ____ city centre?
B: Yes, go straight on and then take ____ next turning left.
7 A: Shall we go out for ____ meal this evening?
B: Yes, that's ____ good idea.
8 It's ____ nice morning. Let's go for ____ walk.
9 Amanda is ____ student. When she finishes her studies, she wants to be ____ journalist. She lives with two friends in ____ apartment near ____ college where she is studying. ____ apartment is small, but she likes it.
10 Peter and Mary have two children, ____ boy and ____ girl. ____ boy is seven years old, and ____ girl is three. Peter works in ____ factory. Mary doesn't have ____ job at the moment.

Complete the sentences. Use a or the + these words:

airport **cup** **dictionary** **~~door~~** **floor** **picture**

These sentences are not correct. Put in a/an or the where necessary.

1 Don't forget to turn off light when you go out. ___turn off the light___
2 Enjoy your trip, and don't forget to send me postcard. ____
3 What is name of this village? ____
4 Canada is very big country. ____
5 What is largest city in Canada? ____
6 I like this room, but I don't like colour of carpet. ____
7 'Are you OK?' 'No, I've got headache.' ____
8 We live in old house near station. ____
9 What is name of director of film we saw last night? ____

Answers

69.1

3 a
4 the
5 an
6 the ... the
7 a ... a
8 a ... a
9 ... **a** student ... **a** journalist ... **an** apartment near **the** college ... **The** apartment is ...
10 ... two children, **a** boy and **a** girl. **The** boy is seven years old, and **the** girl is three ... in **a** factory ... doesn't have **a** job ...

69.2

2 **the** airport
3 **a** cup
4 **a** nice picture
5 **the** dictionary
6 **the** floor

69.3

2 ... send me **a** postcard.
3 What is **the** name of ...
4 ... **a** very big country.
5 What is **the** largest ...
6 ... **the** colour of **the** carpet.
7 ... **a** headache.
8 ... **an** old house near **the** station.
9 ... **the** name of **the** director of **the** film ...